CHAPTER FIFTEEN

TATA CONSUMER PRODUCTS

Engineering Pathways

Tata Consumer Products Limited (TCPL) is a multinational dealing in a vast variety of fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) such as tea, coffee, water and pulses. It is the second-largest player in branded tea in the world and enjoys a significant presence in over forty countries worldwide, employing more than 3,000 people, with factories in India, the UK, Russia and the US. The company has several subsidiaries including Tata Tea Extractions Inc., Tata Coffee Limited and Tata Global Beverages Group Limited, UK.

TCPL started out as Tata Tea Limited, incorporated as a private limited company in 1962. It later became Tata Global Beverages Limited (TGBL) and subsequently TCPL in 2013. The company took on its latest incarnation on 7 February 2020 after the consumer businesses of TGBL and Tata Chemicals were merged.

Ratan took over as chairman of Tata Tea Limited from Darbari Seth in 1995. But even before he assumed charge, the company was significantly influenced by the changes he had brought in all the Tata companies as the head of the Tata Group. The upshot was that it achieved scale, expanded both domestically and internationally, and was modernized. The implementation of his changes in Tata Tea Limited was also helped by a crucial decision he took in May 1991—the appointment of the hard-nosed, no-nonsense, never-say-die Tata Administrative Service (TAS) officer, R.K. Krishna Kumar, as the company's MD. And the Ratan Tata–Krishna Kumar duo engineered a new growth path for the organization.

Achieving Scale